01 | CCEs | FLYER

CCEs: Six Parts of a Clear Message

CLEAR Communication Elements for giving and receiving direction

A clear message answers six questions. If one is missing, people have to guess.

01	**What is changing or being asked** Who does what, and by when?
02	**Why / Why it is changing** What is the reason?
03	**Who owns it and who decides** Who does the work? Who makes the call?
04	**What is not changing** What stays the same?
05	**What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back** Who answers questions, and how soon?
06	**Where this lives (whenever applicable)** Which form, policy, or guide goes with it?

Who this is for

Leaders: CCEs 1–5 are required in written direction under the Administrative Directive. Add CCE 6 when there is a source document. Everyone: use the six questions to find what is missing and ask about it.

Based on: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

01 | CCEs | DESK REFERENCE

CCEs: Quick Message Check

Run through this before you send, forward, or act on work direction.

> **Required for leadership messages**
> Written expectations, changes, decisions, and reminders from leadership need CCEs 1–5. Add CCE 6 when a source document applies. Greetings and "got it" replies are exempt.

Element	Check
1. What is changing or being asked	Who, what, and by when are all stated.
2. Why / Why it is changing	The reason is given.
3. Who owns it and who decides	The worker and the decision-maker are both named.
4. What is not changing	What stays the same is stated.
5. What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back	A contact and a reply time are given.
6. Where this lives (whenever applicable)	The form, policy, or guide is linked or named.

Passing a message along?

Keep the action, reason, deadline, audience, and decision-maker the same. Simpler words are fine. New meaning is not. If something is missing, ask. Don't fill the gap yourself.

Receiving direction?

Say it back in your own words:

> *"So I need to _____ by _____. I'm responsible for _____. I still need to check _____ with _____."*

> **Before you hit send**
> Could someone read this and know the next step, the deadline, and who to ask? If they would have to open a link to find out, add it to the message.

Based on: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

01 | CCEs | RESOURCE

CCEs: A Guide for Leaders and Staff

What each element means and what to write

The CCE Administrative Directive covers written direction from leadership. Staff at any level can use the same six questions to understand an assignment, ask for a missing detail, or hand off work. The CCEs do not change who has approval authority.

What to write for each element

01	**What is changing or being asked** Say who the message is for, what they need to do, and the deadline or start date. If people need to know something on one date and act on another, list both dates.
02	**Why / Why it is changing** Give the reason or the problem the work solves. “Management wants it” doesn’t tell anyone why.
03	**Who owns it and who decides** Name the person who will do the work and the person who will decide. Spell out what the reader can decide on their own.
04	**What is not changing** List the duties, service levels, rules, or approvals that are not affected. Check before you call anything unchanged.
05	**What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back** Name the contact for questions and when they will reply. Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it will take longer, say when the next update is coming.
06	**Where this lives (whenever applicable)** Name the document, its version, and where to find it. If no document applies, skip this one.

> **Every channel counts**
> Emails, chats, forwards, and reminders that give direction need the CCEs that apply. Greetings and replies that just confirm receipt don’t.

Based on: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

01 | CCEs | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

CCEs: Example and Practice

Example only. Swap in your own details.

CCE	Example
1. Action	Service desk team: look over next week's draft coverage schedule and email your supervisor about any conflicts by noon Thursday.
2. Reason	We want to catch coverage gaps before the schedule is locked in.
3. Owners	You check your own availability. Your supervisor approves the final coverage plan.
4. Unchanged	Your current assignments, service hours, approved leave, and duties stay as they are until a change is approved.
5. Questions and reply	Questions go to your supervisor. Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it takes longer, you'll get an update.
6. Source	The current coverage schedule is attached. In a real message, attach the approved file or say where it is saved.

Practice: draft your next message

Use this space	Your notes
What and by when	
Why, and who owns it	
What stays the same	
Who to ask, and source	

Make sure it landed

Ask: "Just to check I was clear, what's your next step?" Listen for the task, the deadline, and who they'd go to for help. If any of those are missing, fix the message.

Rewording is fine. Changing the confirmed task, deadline, or decision-maker is not.

Based on: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

02 | LADDER OF INFERENCE | FLYER

Ladder of Inference: Check the Facts

Slow down before you jump to a conclusion

We move from "what happened" to "what I'll do about it" very fast. Each step up the ladder adds a little of our own interpretation.



START HERE • Read from 1 at the bottom to 7 at the top.

Climb back down

Ask yourself: What do I actually know? What did I add? What question would test it? Get the answer, then decide or escalate.

Watch for the feedback loop: what you already believe changes what you notice next.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."

02 | LADDER OF INFERENCE | DESK REFERENCE

Ladder of Inference: Self-Check

Work through these questions before you decide or ask for a decision.

Step	Question
1. Observe facts	What actually happened?
2. Select information	What did I pay attention to, and what did I skip?
3. Add meaning	What do I think this means?
4. Make assumptions	What am I taking for granted?
5. Draw conclusions	What have I concluded?
6. Form beliefs	What do I now believe is true?
7. Take action	What am I about to do?

Spot the assumption

Fact	Assumption	Better question
The reply said, "Please send your recommendation."	"They've already decided. This is a waste of time."	"What decision is this for, and what should I include?"

Before you decide or escalate

Be clear about the decision. Look up the current policy and who has the authority. Ask the one question that would settle the missing fact. If the answer changes things, change your conclusion.

What I know for sure: _____

What I'm assuming: _____

What I'll ask, and next step: _____

> **Safety first**
> If there's a safety concern or an immediate risk to services, use the urgent process now. Skip this worksheet.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."

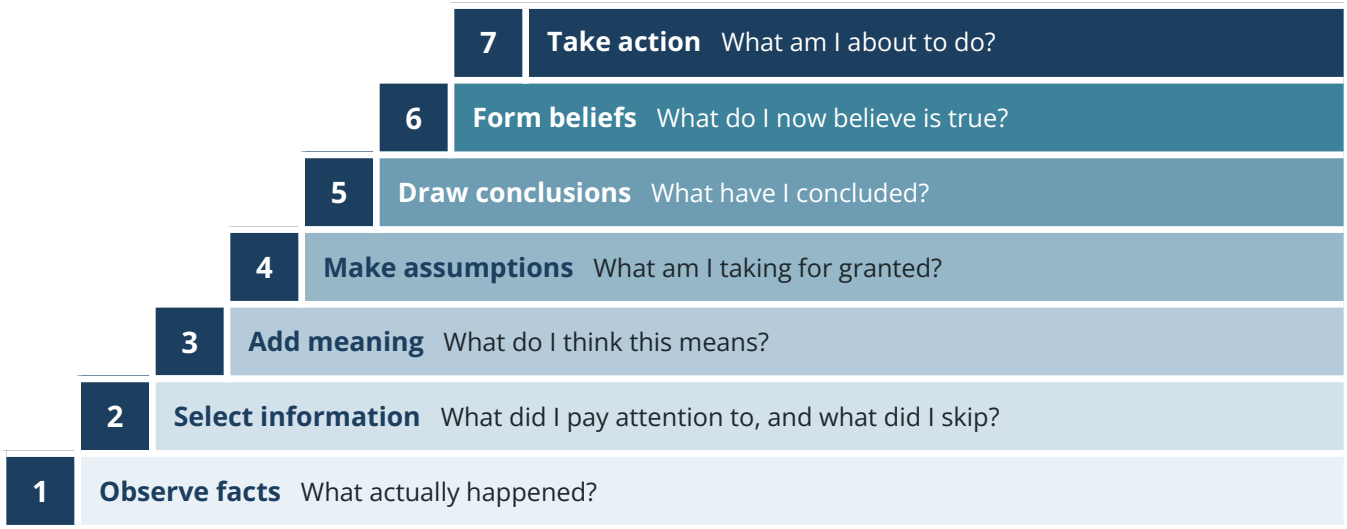
Learn more: Watch the TED-Ed lesson

02 | LADDER OF INFERENCE | RESOURCE

Ladder of Inference: How Assumptions Form

The seven steps between seeing something and acting on it

The Ladder of Inference maps how we get from an observation to an action. Most of the time we climb it without noticing. Knowing the steps makes it easier to catch the moment a guess starts to feel like a fact.



START HERE • Read from 1 at the bottom to 7 at the top.

The feedback loop

What we believe shapes what we notice. If you're sure a coworker never replies, every late answer stands out and the quick ones fade from memory. Look for the evidence that doesn't fit.

> **A tool for yourself**
> Use the ladder to check your own thinking, not to label someone else. Stick to what you saw or heard. Ask a neutral question and listen to the answer. Even a reasonable conclusion may need checking.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."

Learn more: TED-Ed lesson | USC explanation of the seven steps

02 | LADDER OF INFERENCE | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

Ladder of Inference: Example and Practice

Example only. This is not a real County case.

Steps	What happens
1–2. Facts and focus	Your supervisor writes back, "Please send your recommendation." You focus on the request, but you don't know what your supervisor still needs.
3–4. Meaning and assumptions	You take the reply as a brush-off and decide the outcome is already settled. Your supervisor never said either thing.
5–7. Conclusion, belief, and action	You figure your input won't count and the process is pointless. You stall, or you send a frustrated reply.

What to do instead

> **Ask before you assume**
> "I can put together a recommendation. What decision is it for, what should I include, and when do you need it?"

Then sort out who does what. You might own the research while someone else owns the approval. Send the facts you've checked, the open question, and the next step you suggest.

Practice with something current

Use this space	Your notes
What happened	
What I assumed, or another possibility	
Who I'll ask, and what	
My next step	

When your thinking changes

> *"I thought _____. Then I checked _____ and found out _____. Now I'm going to _____."*

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."

03 | EISENHOWER CHART | FLYER

Eisenhower Chart: Sorting Your Work

Decide what to do now, what to schedule, what to pass on, and what to drop

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** Real deadline or service risk. Handle it now through the proper channel.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Planning, prevention, training, and required work. Book time for it before it turns urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Someone else's urgency. Confirm it, then pass it on, delegate it, or reset the timeline if you're allowed to.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** Not required and not useful. Once you've confirmed that, scale it back or drop it.

Protect your Q2 time
Choose one Q2 task this week. Block time for it on your calendar and decide what finished looks like.

Ask two questions

Urgent? What happens if it waits?

Important? Does it support required duties, services, safety, or agreed goals?

Your job duties, your branch RACI, and your supervisor decide what counts as important. Routine required work is still important.

Based on: Time Management in a CLEAR Way workshop. Model: FranklinCovey, The 5 Choices, Choice 1.

03 | EISENHOWER CHART | DESK REFERENCE

Eisenhower Chart: Daily Sort

Check the real deadline, the cost of waiting, and your role before you sort a task.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** Real deadline or service risk. Handle it now through the proper channel.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Planning, prevention, training, and required work. Book time for it before it turns urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Someone else's urgency. Confirm it, then pass it on, delegate it, or reset the timeline if you're allowed to.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** Not required and not useful. Once you've confirmed that, scale it back or drop it.

Urgency: Is the deadline real? What happens if it waits?

Importance: Does it tie to required work, services, safety, or agreed goals?

Authority: Who can change the timing, reassign it, or stop it?

Book one Q2 task today

Use this space	Your notes
Task, and what finished means	
When, and who	

Too many priorities?
Take the deadlines, what's at stake, two options, and your recommendation to the leader who can decide. Get a clear answer on what comes first. Don't drop a required task on your own.

Based on: Time Management in a CLEAR Way workshop. Model: FranklinCovey, The 5 Choices, Choice 1.

Learn more: FranklinCovey: urgency and importance

03 | EISENHOWER CHART | RESOURCE

Eisenhower Chart: Setting Priorities

Sort work by your real duties and the authority you have

Urgent means time-sensitive: something happens if it waits. Important means it matters to required work, services, safety, or agreed goals. Some requests feel urgent but aren't the best use of your time.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** Real deadline or service risk. Handle it now through the proper channel.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Planning, prevention, training, and required work. Book time for it before it turns urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Someone else's urgency. Confirm it, then pass it on, delegate it, or reset the timeline if you're allowed to.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** Not required and not useful. Once you've confirmed that, scale it back or drop it.

Start with your role

Your job duties, your branch RACI, current procedures, and your supervisor's expectations tell you what's important. A request from someone senior still has to be checked against the real service need and deadline.

Office Hours and focus time

Save non-urgent questions for Office Hours or the published support schedule when you can. Use focus time to finish important work, work through requests, and answer messages. Urgent service or safety issues go through the required process right away. Don't hold them for Office Hours.

> **Watch out for these**
> Q3 doesn't mean pushing every urgent request onto someone else. Q4 doesn't mean skipping required work. Before you change or stop anything, make sure it isn't needed and that you're allowed to.

Based on: Time Management in a CLEAR Way workshop. Model: FranklinCovey, The 5 Choices, Choice 1.

Learn more: FranklinCovey: urgency and importance

03 | EISENHOWER CHART | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

Eisenhower Chart: Examples and Planning

Examples only. Your facts and role could put a task in a different box.

Example	Quadrant	What to do
There's no coverage for the next required service window.	Q1	Use the proper process to cover the service risk now.
A better job aid would stop the same questions from coming in.	Q2	Book time to write it and get any review it needs.
Someone wants an optional font change by noon. It doesn't affect the work.	Q3	Check the deadline and the reason. Reset the timeline or reroute it if you're allowed to.
Someone is still polishing an optional flyer for a canceled event.	Q4	Make sure nothing still needs it, then stop or scale it back.

Plan one important task

Use this space	Your notes
Task and why it matters	
Deadline and time blocked	
Quadrant, next step, owner	
What finished looks like	

Look back

Did you use the time you blocked? What got in the way? Did the work cut repeat questions, reduce rework, or help service? Adjust and try again.

> **Commit to a next step**
> "I'll finish _____ during _____. The result will be _____. I need _____ to confirm _____."

Based on: Time Management in a CLEAR Way workshop. Model: FranklinCovey, The 5 Choices, Choice 1.

04 | RACI CHART | FLYER

RACI Chart: Who Does What

Four roles for every task: do it, own it, weigh in, stay informed

R Responsible
Does the work.

A Accountable
Owns the outcome. One A per task.

C Consulted
Weighs in before work starts.

I Informed
Hears about the result.

Put one task or decision on each row. Fill in names or job titles for R, A, C, and I.

Branch / team: _____ **Process / project:** _____

Prepared by: _____ **Review date:** _____

Task or decision	R Responsible	A Accountable	C Consulted	I Informed
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Double-check

Every row needs an R and one A. They can be the same person. If a role isn't settled, write "To confirm" and check through the usual approval process.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 11–12. Follow your branch's approved guidance.

04 | RACI CHART | DESK REFERENCE

RACI Chart: Blank Template

Add names or job titles. Start a new row whenever the decision-maker changes.

R does the work. **A** owns the outcome. **C** gives input before action. **I** receives updates.

Branch / team: _____ **Process / project:** _____

Prepared by: _____ **Review date:** _____

Task or decision	R Responsible	A Accountable	C Consulted	I Informed
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Check before you use it

Every task has an R and exactly one A, and they can be the same person. The right people are listed as C and I. The chart matches current authority and approved procedures.

Source / limits: _____

Open questions: _____

> **A chart is not an approval**
> Filling this out doesn't give anyone approval authority. It doesn't replace your branch's approved RACI or the Decision & Permission Matrix.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 11–12. Follow your branch's approved guidance.

04 | RACI CHART | RESOURCE

RACI Chart: Assigning Roles

How to fill in a RACI chart with your team. A blank chart is on page 2.

A RACI chart lays out who is involved in a task and in what way. It separates the person doing the work from the person who answers for the result, and shows who should weigh in or be kept informed.

Role	Meaning	Ask
R • Responsible	Does the task or carries out the agreed work.	Who's doing it?
A • Accountable	Owns the outcome and the decision that goes with it. One A per task.	Who answers for it?
C • Consulted	Provides needed information before a decision or action.	Whose input is needed?
I • Informed	Is told about the result so they can understand it or act on it.	Who needs to know?

Four steps to build it

01 **One task or decision per row**
If different people prepare, approve, and carry out the work, split those into separate rows.

02 **Pick the R and one A**
Check who has the authority today. Name an R and one A. The same person can be both.

03 **Add the C and I**
Name who needs to weigh in and who needs to hear the result. Being consulted doesn't make someone the owner.

04 **Review it and keep it current**
Go over it with the people involved and the leader who has authority. Write down the source, any open questions, and a review date.

> **Owner unclear?**
> Write "To confirm" and name who will find out. Until it's settled, stick to the work you already have authority to do.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 11–12. Definitions: Cornell IT. **Learn more:** Cornell IT definitions

04 | RACI CHART | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

RACI Chart: Team Worksheet

Fill this in together. Use names or job titles.

Branch / team: _____ **Process / project:** _____

Prepared by: _____ **Review date:** _____

Task or decision	R Responsible	A Accountable	C Consulted	I Informed
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

R does the work. **A** owns the outcome. **C** gives input before action. **I** receives updates.

Use this space	Your notes
Source and version	
Scope and limits	
Open question and owner	

Confirmed with: _____ **Next review:** _____

Final check

One task or decision per row. At least one R. Exactly one A. Any questions about authority go through the usual approval process.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 11–12. Follow your branch's approved guidance.

05 | RESPECTFUL REVERSAL | FLYER

Respectful Reversal: Changing Course

Five steps for explaining a change

01	**Recognize** Say what was decided and what was known when it was decided.
02	**Explain** Say what is new: the information, risk, or limit that changes things.
03	**Own** Take responsibility for the change and for making it clear.
04	**Direct** Say what happens next, when, and what help is available.
05	**Clarify** Say whether this is a one-time change or a new rule.

> **No blame**
> Talk about what changed and what comes next. People who followed the direction they were given did the right thing.

On the receiving end?

Ask what's changing, why, when, and who it affects. Confirm your next step, what help you'll have, and what's still yours to do.

Based on: Safe to Decide training, Supervisor edition, slides 23–25.

05 | RESPECTFUL REVERSAL | DESK REFERENCE

Respectful Reversal: Conversation Guide

For when you have authority to change a decision, or need to explain an approved change.

Step	Cover this	Try saying
1. Recognize	The original decision and what was known then.	"You went with the information we had."
2. Explain	The new fact, risk, or limit.	"Now we know _____, so _____ needs to change."
3. Own	Your part in giving clear direction and following up.	"This is on me to make clear."
4. Direct	Next step, timing, and help.	"Here's what happens next: _____. You'll have _____."
5. Clarify	One-time change or new rule.	"This applies to _____. _____ isn't changing."

Before you talk

Check the facts. Make sure you have the authority. Decide the next step and what help you can give. Only call the first decision reasonable or authorized if the facts back that up.

Hearing about a change?

Say it back:

> *"OK, so now I'll _____ by _____. I'm still responsible for _____. This applies to _____. If I need help, I'll go to _____."*

> **Writing it up**
> Use the CCEs that apply. State the decision, give the reason, and make the next step clear for everyone it affects.

Based on: Safe to Decide training, Supervisor edition, slides 23–25.

05 | RESPECTFUL REVERSAL | RESOURCE

Respectful Reversal: Leading Through a Change

How to change direction while keeping roles and responsibilities clear

New facts sometimes mean a decision has to change. Handled well, the conversation helps people understand why and get back to work with confidence. Use these steps when you change direction within your authority or explain a change someone else approved.

01	**Recognize** Say what was decided and what was known at the time. Acknowledge the reasoning behind it. Check the facts before you call the decision authorized or reasonable.
02	**Explain** Describe what's new: the information, service risk, or limit that means the decision has to change. Talk about the work, not the person.
03	**Own** Own your part in the first direction and the new one. Don't pin it on staff, and don't pass along a change without explaining it.
04	**Direct** Lay out what happens next, when, who does it, and what help is available. Flag any decision that still needs someone with authority.
05	**Clarify** Make clear whether the change is for this situation only or for a wider process. A one-time fix isn't a new rule.

If you're receiving the change

Ask about anything that wasn't covered. Say back what you'll do, what you can still decide, and who will help. When you pass the change on, keep the meaning the same and leave blame out of it.

> **Respect and accountability go together**
> Being respectful doesn't mean skipping a required review. It means keeping the facts, expectations, help, and responsibilities clear while the work gets fixed.

Based on: Safe to Decide training, Supervisor edition, slides 23–25.

05 | RESPECTFUL REVERSAL | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

Respectful Reversal: Example and Planning

Example only: a confirmed coverage gap means today's assignments change for one day.

Step	Try saying
1. Recognize	"You planned today around the coverage schedule we confirmed."
2. Explain	"We've got a coverage gap in the afternoon service window, so today's assignments need to change."
3. Own	"It's on me to make the new plan clear and help the team make it work."
4. Direct	"This afternoon, please follow the revised assignment. I'll help get the word out and line up support before the window opens."
5. Clarify	"This is just for today. Tomorrow's schedule and the normal approval process aren't changing."

Plan the conversation

Use this space	Your notes
First decision and facts	
What's new, and why	
My part	
Next step and help	
One time or new rule?	

Did it land?

Ask: "What's your next step, and what help do you still need?" Then settle who will tell anyone else affected and whether a written CCE message or an updated document is needed.

Based on: Safe to Decide training, Supervisor edition, slides 23–25.

06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | FLYER

Clear Requests: Asking for a Decision

Six steps for requests, escalations, and follow-ups

01	**Name the exact decision** Say exactly what you need: an answer, an approval, or a clarification.
02	**Check authority and boundaries** Check current guidance. Know what you can decide and what needs someone else.
03	**Gather facts and required input** Separate what you know from what you're assuming. Include what the decision-maker needs.
04	**Offer options and a recommendation** Lay out the options and say which one you recommend.
05	**Check who decides and the deadline** Find out who makes the call, the real deadline, and when you'll hear back.
06	**Follow up and share the outcome** Write down the answer, confirm the next step, and let the right people know.

> **Silence isn't a yes**
> Decide how you'll track the reply before you send. When you hear back, confirm the next step. No answer doesn't mean approved.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.

06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | DESK REFERENCE

Clear Requests: Before You Send

Use for a decision request, an escalation, or a follow-up.

Step	Check
1. Name the exact decision	Will the reader know exactly what I'm asking for?
2. Check authority and boundaries	What can I decide or keep doing? What needs someone else?
3. Gather facts and required input	What do I know for sure? What's still unconfirmed? Whose input do I need?
4. Offer options and a recommendation	What are my real options? Which do I recommend, and why?
5. Check who decides and the deadline	Who decides? Is the deadline real? When will I hear back?
6. Follow up and share the outcome	Who's tracking this, doing the next step, and updating others?

Keep track of three dates

Decision needed by: _____ **Reply expected by:** _____

Next update, if still open: _____ **Confirmed with:** _____

Following up

Point back to your original request and the update date you agreed on. Say what's still open, what's new, and what happens if it waits. Check for a reply before you send it again.

> **How fast to expect an answer**
> Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it'll take longer, expect a date for the next update. Immediate risks and required deadlines go through the urgent process.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.

06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | RESOURCE

Clear Requests: Escalating the Right Way

Hand off the decision. Keep doing your part.

01	**Name the exact decision** Get specific. “Which coverage option is approved?” works better than “Can you deal with this?” Say whether you need an answer, an approval, or a clarification.
02	**Check authority and boundaries** Look at the current role guidance, your branch RACI, and the Decision & Permission Matrix. Sort out what’s yours and what belongs to someone else.
03	**Gather facts and required input** Use current sources and confirmed facts. Point out what’s missing. Get the input you need, and don’t pass off a guess as a fact.
04	**Offer options and a recommendation** Offer two workable options when you can. Show what each means for services, resources, and trade-offs. If only one works, say why.
05	**Check who decides and the deadline** Confirm who decides, when the decision is needed, when you’ll hear back, and when the next update is due. A date you asked for isn’t a date someone agreed to.
06	**Follow up and share the outcome** Before you send, decide who will follow up. After you hear back, write down the answer, confirm the next step and who owns it, and update the people affected.

An answer isn’t always a fix

Within two working days you’ll get an answer or the name of the person handling your question. That doesn’t mean the issue will be solved by then. If it needs more time, confirm when the next update is coming. Urgent issues go through the required process right away.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.

06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

Clear Requests: Worksheet and Examples

Use real facts, approved sources, and confirmed dates.

Step	Your request
What I need decided	
Authority and source	
Facts and input	
Options and my pick	
Who decides, and when	
Follow-up and next step	

Sample request

Coverage decision

"We need a decision between two coverage options. The attached summary lays out the gap, both options, and the input we got. I recommend option A because it keeps the service window covered. We need an answer before the window opens. Can you tell me who will decide and when we'll hear back? I'll watch for the reply and update the team."

Example only.

Following up

"Following up on my request from _____. We'd agreed on an update by _____. Still open: _____. What's new: _____. If this waits, _____. Can you send the answer, who's handling it, or when the next update will be?"

Once you have an answer

Write down the decision and any limits. Confirm who does what and by when. Let the affected people know. Until it's approved, stick to the work you already have authority to do.

Based on: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.